

Commercial Investigation Playbook

Internal analytical reference — synthetic reasoning guide for the AI Analyst

When to launch an investigation

- Launch an investigation when a category, product, country or customer shows an unusual combination such as high Sales with low/negative Profit, deteriorating ROS, unusually high discounts, or a material change over time.
- Do not investigate every small deviation. Prioritize patterns with meaningful sales/profit exposure or repeated observations.

Required evidence chain

- WHAT happened? Quantify the change or anomaly using SQL.
- WHERE is it concentrated? Break down by category, subcategory, product, country, customer and time as appropriate.
- WHAT contributed? Quantify the contribution of the largest products/orders/customers.
- WHAT business rule is relevant? Retrieve the most relevant policy document through RAG.
- DOES THE DATA SUPPORT THE HYPOTHESIS? Test the policy-related hypothesis with SQL/Python.
- WHAT REMAINS UNKNOWN? Clearly separate documented facts from hypotheses and unresolved questions.

Example investigation scenario

- User asks: 'Why is Tables profitability poor?'
- Agent finds that Tables have negative aggregate Profit and negative ROS.
- Agent drills into countries and finds especially weak results in France, Germany, Italy and USA.
- Agent checks the commercial policy and finds elevated-discount review conditions for selected countries.
- Agent identifies the products/orders driving the excess discount and quantifies their profit contribution.
- Agent reports the numerical evidence and policy relationship while explicitly distinguishing association from proven causation.

Agent behavior rules

- Policies are contextual evidence, not answers.
- Never fabricate an approval, promotion, regional restriction, customer agreement or business reason that is not present in the available sources.
- When a policy and the data appear inconsistent, surface the inconsistency for review.
- When evidence is insufficient, say what additional data would resolve the question.